

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

Kucetekela Foundation_Zambia_2022-23_3-month report

Fellowship Organization

Kucetekela Foundation (KF)

Fellowship City

Lusaka

Fellowship Country

Zambia

Fellowship Start Date

08/01/2022

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/01/2023

What is your fellowship title/role?

Program Coordinator

What are your primary responsibilities?

The programs coordinator will be responsible for writing and recording information for students regarding their background, Academic and social life. He/she needs to identify students who are academically excelling but financially disadvantaged in society in order to receive a five year scholarship to pursue a secondary education. He/She needs to work closely with Kucetekela Foundation members of staff, parents, school administrators to improve student's academic progress as well as facilitating capacity building programs in Leadership, social behavior, internship and community service. Need to monitor the application process to tertiary and liaise with different organization for engaging students in seminars and internship jobs.

- To mentor, nurture, and guide teenage students sponsored by Kucetekela Foundation in different schools in Lusaka
- Attend to the general welfare of students in boarding houses in terms of their upkeep, educational needs, and general welfare
- Interact with various stakeholders by serving as boundary spanner or link-pin
- Plan ahead to forestall problems incidental to the job
- Hold interviews for selection of new students for the programme
- Hold orientation for newly appointed mentors
- Arrange meetings for student mentees to meet their mentors
- Make overseas travelling arrangements for students attending conferences or those admitted to overseas universities and colleges
- Prepare work plans, annual reports, student newsletters through desktop editing and publishing
- Maintain accurate and updated records of students' profiles
- Attend to all manner of correspondence between KF and external stakeholders
- Plan for students' placement in organizations for job experience and job shadowing
- Undertake guidance and counseling assignments regarding students' future careers and help them write motivation essays for acceptance into overseas universities
- Help prepare students for TOEFEL and SAT examinations
- Arrange student interviews to screen them for awards and external scholarships/travel opportunities
- Supervise students during community service assignments
- Monitor on a continuous basis the academic progress of students sponsored by KF in various schools and to communicate their progress reports to sponsors
- Train mentors and students when called upon to do so
- Explore opportunities for and search for further external sponsors and collaborators
- Undertake any other job which will be incidental to the job as directed.

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

This was handled by the supervisors and the interns. I had a meeting with each one. We discussed responsibilities.

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?
Describe a representative day at work.

My days at KF vary. There is no one day that is the same. Some days are spent in the office, other days are spent on the road. The days spent on the road we are travelling to our two partner schools PEC Pestalozzi Education Centre and Chalo Trust school. Here we meet our various students and hear what their concerns are. It is during these visits we attend the students' events and we support them with various college applications and scholarships. Some other days include recruitment. Here we travel to various government schools in Lusaka interviewing students. Some days I am visiting some of the students' families in various parts of Lusaka. Some weekends there are events that we attend at the various students' schools. Sometimes we will attend community service events or projects that happen on weekends.

Days usually start at 8:30 and can end around 6. This really depends on the day. Some days I will be working with students on applications, other days will be spent at the office. The schedule is very flexible. Some days you can work from home, other days this may not be a possibility.

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

This varies week to week. Although it says 40 hours on the contract the likelihood of working more hours is certain. I am working closer to 50-60 hours. This is because some weekend work is necessary.

Very Effective

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?**Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.**

One project I have been working on is developing the communications and marketing material for KF. I have created a termly newsletter that is sent out to students, parents, board members and other community members. This required photography/videography skills, editing skills and writing skills. I created 2 newsletters. Throughout this process I was working closely with all team members and reaching out to the students.

Another project that I have been working on is developing the mentorship program at KF. Each of our students is paired with a mentor in the community. Many of our mentors work in various careers and industries. My work has been looking to onboard new mentors, connect with old mentors. Another component of my work includes improving the mentorship program. I have been developing a feedback survey to be sent out to all mentors and mentees. This survey is collecting data and information on how to improve the mentorship program at KF. I am currently writing a report on my various findings.

I have been working with students on their various college applications and scholarship writing.

I developed a KF Challenge Thank you Video. I went to visit students families and the students and edited and produced a film about the impact KF has had on the students. This video has been edited.

I have also been working to ensure our students are on track with their applications

What is your organization's work culture like?**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

The office that I currently work in is very small. There is about 7-8 people in the office. We have 3 supervisors, two administrative/associate staff and me. We also have a staff driver and one staff member that helps with the maintenance of the offices. We have a headquarters office in NY. I do most of my work with the two administrative/associates at the office.

To whom do you report?

Co-Founder and Executive Director are often in communication. I get approval on any projects or items from her. We are frequently in contact.

Co-Founder and Finance and Administration Manager. We work on any finances that may be involved at KF. And during staff meetings.

Programs Manager . I work most closely with him. As he is the Programs Manager and I am the Programs coordinator. We collaborate on projects and edit each others work

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes.

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.**Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

- Meet all the students and teachers!
- Host at least 3-4 workshops.
- Connect KF students to unique internship and work experience opportunities.
- Connect KF and my students to mentors in Lusaka and Globally
- Increase funding at KF
- Pre-College (Get some of my KF students to go to a Pre-College Program Fully funded).
- Incorporate arts and social sciences in a programme

Do you receive adequate direction/support to perform your fellowship responsibilities?**Please provide more information on your response above.**

N/a

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

No

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).**I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.**

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I think PiAf did an amazing job in pairing fellows with the organization. I think my previous internships and work experience lines up with the work that is being done at KF.

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I purchased my tickets from Boston to London. And then from London to Nairobi. I spent a few weeks in Nairobi, Kenya before heading to Lusaka, Zambia. I bought my tickets on Skyscanner.

From Boston to London and from London to Nairobi, I used BA British Airways. The cost was USD \$1,100 USD
I used Kenya Airways for my trip from Nairobi to Lusaka. This one-way ticket cost roughly \$400 USD.

I do not have a return ticket just yet. As I was unable to buy a ticket that far in advance. I will buy my ticket in about 6 months or about halfway through my PiAf fellowship.

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Employment Visa 1 year

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Through host organization

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Yes. I received it a few days before my departure.

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$50 USD

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Yes I paid for the Visa. However, KF will cover the costs and reimburse you. However, I have not been reimbursed yet.

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Make sure to get this process started as early as possible! Make sure to communicate with your host organization.

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

N/A. I had all vaccinations beforehand.

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

First week was good. My host organization however mentioned there would be a host family that they could pair me with for my first month in Lusaka. However, they did not let me know I had a host family until a week before my departure to Lusaka. And I had already signed a lease and organized housing/payment. The process that can be streamlined is the communication. For future fellows make sure to communicate early on with your host org. make sure you have details at least two months in advance. Make sure to connect with past fellows etc.

First week in Lusaka was overall good. The host org did a good job in orienting me to the organization.

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Housing is not provided and housing not paid for by the host organization. There is an option to have a host family for the first month in Lusaka. However, for my first month I found housing and a flat. This was recommended by a previous PiAf fellow. This previous fellow gave me suggestions of housing options.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

Please describe your living environment

I live in a flat that is located next to the International School of Lusaka. This is near Longacre's and Rhodespark.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I travel from home to work by using the KF staff bus. The cost is free. However, it takes about an hour and a half to two hours each way. This adds up to 3-4 hours a day commuting So we can easily spend several hours picking up staff members or commuting back and forth from work. This can also change depending on if there is traffic and the weather.

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

N/A

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

It is very dry here in Lusaka. It is summer/hot weather, and it is quite dusty. It has not rained in almost two months now. The city is currently going through a drought. Aug-Nov very hot and dry. Rainy season will start in November/December

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Clothing is business casual and overall formal when going to work.

How have you been spending your free time?

Free time includes, reading, engaging with different events and functions happening in Lusaka. Going down to the Lower Zambezi. Going to museums and exploring the city. I have been playing frisbee and learning how to dance Afro-beats and Salsa.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

The PiAf family has been so supportive and amazing!

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes! The area is very safe. However, I would not walk around alone at night.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

Locks on doors. Ensuring people know where you are going at all times. Being aware of surroundings and knowing the destination location.

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

N/A

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Safe housing areas: Rhodespark, Longacres, Kabulonga, Ibex Hill.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

I am still working on many of my goals. However, I think I am making good progress in achieving some of these goals. No goals have been changed. However, the organization is super open and willing to provide support in making progress towards the various goals.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

Not too many. Work-wise: I think communication styles and timeliness is a small frustration. In addition, our organization is very small and the org. does not get much funding. So this can impact if we have wifi, water, or gas to complete work activities. The lack of funding to the org. can impact work. However, these are often addressed within a few weeks. And I know the organization is working hard to improve some of these challenges at work.

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

N/A

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I have not really dealt with much culture shock. I think the only thing is the timeliness of activities and timeline of some projects.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

The wide impact the organization is having. The scholarships are not only helping the students directly but are having a huge impact on the families and the community. I did not realize this until I was speaking to family members and community members. I was surprised, in pleasant way. It is incredible to see how \$4000 USD can impact a family's life for several years. It was interesting to see the generational impact this organization has had on everyone. I think I was surprised as to how hands on the work was and the different hats I would be wearing. I do grant writing, college counselor work, video editing, community interviewing, mentorship, outreach, to shopping for materials for the students, I talk to parents and the students on a daily. I love the dynamics and the different roles I have been able to take on at the organization.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

I think the most challenging has been the recruitment and selection of students into the scholarship. We interview hundreds of students and have to narrow it down to 10 students and then down to 6 student who will receive this scholarship. We often go into the Zambian government schools, and to see the conditions that the schools are in, the limited supplies, packed classrooms, broken materials and the lack of support several of the students we are interviewing is quite challenging. The lack of funding at the various government schools is very challenging to see.

Another challenge is that some of our own scholarship students through the org. do not have access to technology or WIFI. This makes it very challenging for us to work with our kids. They often are unable to complete their college applications or school essays because they do not have the technology. They often have to borrow friends' technologies or they have to stay later after school or late at night in the schools computer lab which closes at a certain time. It can be quite hard to get in contact with the students because of this.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

- Mobile money (everything is very cash reliant here requiring one to go to the ATM often)
- Weather / ocean (East-Africa)
- Easy /affordable transport

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

- Food and food prices
- People friendliness and welcoming nature
- Weather (Beats weather in the Northeast of the U.S.)

How is your stipend being paid?

- Stipend is paid every 5 months. This is paid in U.S. dollars and goes straight to my U.S. bank account. This is quite helpful as landlords in Lusaka want 2-3 months of rent in advance.

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

- I did not raise funds and do not receive any support. I worked 3 jobs over the summer to try and save money for my fellowship years. I was interning for two organizations part time and babysitting. I also went into my savings from the previous years. I have not taken on any additional work during my fellowship year.

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$650.00	\$19.96	\$40.00	\$12.00	\$10.00	\$9.97
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$29.97	\$20.00	\$10.00	\$120.13	\$15.02	\$20.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$20.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$28.00	\$0.00	995.05
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

I am so grateful I was in person at the orientation. I have made so many wonderful connections with my co-fellows. I really think being in person for orientation should be emphasized. It was such a wonderful experience!

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

Not that I can think about at the moment. You all did an excellent job. I think perhaps finances and financial management with the stipends etc. financial planning workshop could be helpful. I think also a degree of transparency with stipends and countries is also helpful. So as fellows we can plan how much money to save before our fellowship post. For example, my self I was in school and when straight from my B.A. to M.A. and although I was working several jobs during my studies and over breaks. All of these funds were mainly going to pay for school. Thus, coming into the fellowship I had saved some money, but not as much as I had hoped for. I think more transparency earlier on in the application process and even during orientation on financial management and stipends could be very helpful! For example something I had not anticipated was the foreign transaction fees, moving costs etc. Many of us are just graduating schools and may not have had years and years to build wealth or save. I think a financial management or assistance form or workshop would be helpful as we plan. Perhaps looking at how other fellows in the past spent money and using this as a base for how future fellows stipends should/could look.

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

Support with after PiAf experience. Career-wise..what to do and what are the opportunities following your PiAf year.
How has the fellowship year impacted you?
Identity, race, gender, and development work.
Mid-Year reflection.